

Production Deployment Checklist

Complete pre-launch checklist for AuthiChain production deployment.

Overview

This checklist ensures your AuthiChain platform is production-ready, secure, and performing optimally.

Estimated Time: 4-6 hours (first deployment)

Pre-Deployment Phase

1. Documentation Review

- ☐ Read [PRODUCTION_SETUP.md](#) (./PRODUCTION_SETUP.md) completely
 - ☐ Read [API_KEYS_SETUP.md](#) (./API_KEYS_SETUP.md) for all API keys
 - ☐ Read [STRIPE_PRICE_SETUP.md](#) (./STRIPE_PRICE_SETUP.md) for pricing
 - ☐ Choose deployment platform:
 - ☐ [DEPLOYMENT_VERCEL.md](#) (./DEPLOYMENT_VERCEL.md)
 - ☐ [DEPLOYMENT_RAILWAY.md](#) (./DEPLOYMENT_RAILWAY.md)
 - ☐ [DEPLOYMENT_AWS.md](#) (./DEPLOYMENT_AWS.md)
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2. Domain & DNS

- ☐ **Domain purchased** (from GoDaddy, Namecheap, etc.)
- ☐ **Domain ownership verified**
- ☐ **DNS nameservers updated** (if using hosting provider's DNS)
- ☐ **A record configured** (points to hosting platform)
- ☐ **CNAME for www configured** (optional but recommended)
- ☐ **DNS propagation complete** (check at dnschecker.org)
- ☐ **Email forwarding configured** (optional, for admin@authichain.com)

Time to Complete: 30-60 minutes (+ 24 hours for DNS propagation)

Security Configuration

3. API Keys & Secrets

- ☐ **NFT.Storage API Key obtained**
- Account created at nft.storage
- API key generated
- Tested with sample upload

- ☐ **Stripe Account Fully Activated**

- Business information verified
- Banking details added
- Tax information completed
- Identity verified (if required)
- Account status: "Active" in dashboard

- ☐ **Stripe LIVE Keys obtained**

- Secret key (sk_live_*) copied
- Publishable key (pk_live_*) copied
- Webhook secret (whsec_*) copied
- All keys stored securely

- ☐ **NextAuth Secret generated**

- Random 32+ character string
- Different from development secret
- Stored securely

- ☐ **All secrets documented**

- Stored in password manager (1Password, LastPass, etc.)
- Backup copy in secure location
- Access limited to necessary team members

Time to Complete: 45-60 minutes

4. Database Setup

- ☐ **Production database created**

- Choose provider:
 - ☐ Railway
 - ☐ Supabase
 - ☐ AWS RDS
- Instance provisioned
- Strong password set

- ☐ **Connection string obtained**

- Format verified: `postgresql://user:pass@host:5432/db`
- Connection tested from local machine
- Accessible from hosting platform

- ☐ **Security configured**

- Firewall rules set (if applicable)
- IP whitelist configured (if applicable)
- SSL/TLS encryption enabled

- Public access restricted (production best practice)

- ☐ **Backups enabled**

- Automated daily backups enabled
- Backup retention: 7-30 days
- Restore process tested (critical!)

- ☐ **Database migrations ready**

- Prisma schema up-to-date
- Migration scripts tested locally
- Seed data prepared (if needed)

Time to Complete: 30-45 minutes

Payment Configuration

5. Stripe Products & Pricing

- ☐ **All 15 Price IDs created** (see [STRIPE_PRICE_SETUP.md](#) (./STRIPE_PRICE_SETUP.md))

Starter Tier:

- ☐ Monthly: \$29 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Annual: \$290 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Lifetime: \$497 (price_live_...)

Professional Tier:

- ☐ Monthly: \$79 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Annual: \$790 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Lifetime: \$1,297 (price_live_...)

Business Tier:

- ☐ Monthly: \$199 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Annual: \$1,990 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Lifetime: \$2,997 (price_live_...)

Enterprise Tier:

- ☐ Monthly: \$499 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Annual: \$4,990 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Lifetime: \$7,997 (price_live_...)

White Label Tier:

- ☐ Monthly: \$1,499 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Annual: \$14,990 (price_live_...)
- ☐ Lifetime: \$24,997 (price_live_...)

- ☐ **Price IDs copied to spreadsheet** (for reference)
- ☐ **All prices verified** (correct amounts, billing periods)

Time to Complete: 45-60 minutes

6. Stripe Webhook Configuration

- ☐ **Webhook endpoint created**
- URL: `https://authichain.com/api/stripe/webhook`
- LIVE mode enabled (not test!)
- ☐ **Events selected:**
 - ☐ `checkout.session.completed`
 - ☐ `customer.subscription.created`
 - ☐ `customer.subscription.updated`
 - ☐ `customer.subscription.deleted`
 - ☐ `invoice.payment_succeeded`
 - ☐ `invoice.payment_failed`
 - ☐ `payment_intent.succeeded`
 - ☐ `payment_intent.payment_failed`
- ☐ **Webhook signing secret copied**
- ☐ **Webhook tested** (using Stripe CLI or test event)

Time to Complete: 15-20 minutes

Hosting & Deployment

7. Environment Variables

- ☐ **All variables configured in hosting platform:**

Required:

- ☐ `DATABASE_URL`
- ☐ `NEXTAUTH_SECRET`
- ☐ `NEXTAUTH_URL`
- ☐ `STRIPE_SECRET_KEY`
- ☐ `NEXT_PUBLIC_STRIPE_PUBLISHABLE_KEY`
- ☐ `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET`
- ☐ All 15 `STRIPE_*_PRICE_ID` variables
- ☐ `NFT_STORAGE_API_KEY`
- ☐ `NEXT_PUBLIC_SITE_URL`
- ☐ `NODE_ENV=production`

Optional but Recommended:

- ☐ Email service (SMTP or SendGrid)
- ☐ Monitoring (Sentry, LogRocket)
- ☐ Analytics (Google Analytics, PostHog)
- ☐ **No hardcoded secrets in code**
- ☐ `.env` files in `.gitignore`
- ☐ **Production secrets different from development**

Time to Complete: 20-30 minutes

8. Code Repository

- ☐ **Git repository clean**
 - No sensitive files committed
 - `.gitignore` properly configured
 - No test data or mock credentials
- ☐ **Code pushed to main branch**
 - Latest version deployed
 - No pending changes
 - Tags created for version tracking
- ☐ **GitHub/GitLab access configured**
 - Hosting platform has read access
 - Deployment keys set up
 - Webhooks configured (for auto-deploy)

Time to Complete: 10-15 minutes

9. Application Deployment

- ☐ **Application built successfully**
 - No build errors
 - All dependencies installed
 - TypeScript compilation successful
- ☐ **Database migrations run**
 - Prisma schema pushed to database
 - All tables created
 - Indexes created
 - Seed data loaded (if applicable)
- ☐ **Application started**
 - Server running without errors
 - Health check endpoint responding
 - Logs showing normal operation
- ☐ **Public URL accessible**
 - Homepage loads correctly
 - No 500 errors
 - Assets loading (images, CSS, JS)

Time to Complete: 20-30 minutes (+ 5-10 minutes for build)

10. SSL Certificate

- ☐ **SSL certificate issued**
 - Certificate status: Active
 - Valid for your domain
 - Auto-renewal enabled
- ☐ **HTTPS working**
 - `https://authichain.com` loads
 - No security warnings
 - Padlock icon visible in browser
- ☐ **HTTP redirects to HTTPS**
 - Test `http://authichain.com`
 - Should redirect to HTTPS
- ☐ **Certificate chain valid**
 - Test at `ssllabs.com`
 - Grade: A or A+ recommended

Time to Complete: 5-10 minutes (+ wait for issuance)



Testing Phase

11. Functional Testing

Authentication

- ☐ **User registration works**
 - New user can sign up
 - Email validation (if enabled)
 - User redirected to dashboard
- ☐ **User login works**
 - Can log in with credentials
 - Session persists
 - Remember me works (if enabled)
- ☐ **Password reset works** (if enabled)
 - Reset email sent
 - Reset link works
 - Password changed successfully
- ☐ **Logout works**
 - User logged out
 - Session cleared

- Redirect to homepage

Subscription Flow

- ☐ **Pricing page displays correctly**
- All 5 tiers visible
- Prices correct for all billing cycles
- Features listed accurately
- ☐ **Checkout flow works (LIVE TEST!)**
- ☐ Select Starter Monthly tier
- ☐ Click "Subscribe"
- ☐ Stripe Checkout opens
- ☐ Use REAL credit card (will charge!)
- ☐ Payment processes successfully
- ☐ Redirected back to app
- ☐ Subscription active in database
- ☐ User access level updated

 **Important:** Test with real credit card in LIVE mode!
You can cancel immediately after testing.

- ☐ **Subscription management works**
- ☐ View current subscription
- ☐ Cancel subscription
- ☐ Upgrade tier
- ☐ Downgrade tier
- ☐ Update payment method
- ☐ **Webhook events processed**
- ☐ Check Stripe Dashboard → Webhooks
- ☐ All events show 200 OK
- ☐ Database updated correctly
- ☐ User notified (if applicable)

NFT Functionality

- ☐ **NFT minting works**
- ☐ Upload image (< 10MB)
- ☐ Fill in NFT details
- ☐ Click "Mint NFT"
- ☐ NFT created in database
- ☐ Image uploaded to IPFS
- ☐ IPFS URL generated
- ☐ **IPFS URLs accessible**
- ☐ Test IPFS URL in browser
- ☐ Image loads correctly
- ☐ Metadata accessible

- [] Multiple gateways work
- [] **NFT gallery works**
- [] View all NFTs
- [] Search works
- [] Filters work
- [] Pagination works
- [] **NFT detail page works**
- [] View single NFT
- [] Image displays
- [] Metadata shows
- [] Owner information displayed

Time to Complete: 60-90 minutes

12. Performance Testing

- [] **Page load speed**
- Homepage: < 2 seconds
- NFT Gallery: < 3 seconds
- NFT Detail: < 2 seconds
- Test at: pagespeed.web.dev
- [] **Image optimization**
- Next.js Image component used
- WebP format served
- Lazy loading enabled
- [] **Database performance**
- Query response time < 100ms
- Indexes on frequently queried fields
- Connection pooling enabled
- [] **API response times**
- All API routes < 500ms
- Error handling in place
- Rate limiting enabled

Tools: Google Lighthouse, PageSpeed Insights, GTmetrix

Time to Complete: 30-45 minutes

13. Security Testing

- ☐ **HTTPS enforced**
 - All HTTP requests redirect to HTTPS
 - No mixed content warnings
- ☐ **Security headers configured**
 - Content-Security-Policy
 - X-Frame-Options: DENY
 - X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff
 - Referrer-Policy
 - Permissions-Policy
- ☐ **Authentication secure**
 - Sessions expire correctly
 - CSRF protection enabled
 - No JWT in localStorage (use httpOnly cookies)
- ☐ **API endpoints protected**
 - Auth required where needed
 - Rate limiting active
 - Input validation in place
- ☐ **Database queries safe**
 - No SQL injection vulnerabilities
 - Prisma ORM used correctly
 - User input sanitized
- ☐ **Secrets not exposed**
 - No API keys in frontend code
 - Environment variables not logged
 - Error messages don't leak info

Tools: Mozilla Observatory, Security Headers, OWASP ZAP

Time to Complete: 45-60 minutes



Monitoring & Analytics

14. Error Tracking

- ☐ **Sentry configured** (or alternative)
 - Account created
 - DSN added to environment variables
 - Test error sent successfully
 - Alerts configured

- Team members added
- ☐ **Error logging works**
- 500 errors captured
- JavaScript errors captured
- API errors captured
- Context included (user, request, etc.)

Time to Complete: 20-30 minutes

15. Analytics

- ☐ **Google Analytics configured** (or alternative)
- Tracking ID added
- Events firing correctly
- Real-time data showing
- ☐ **Key events tracked:**
- ☐ User registration
- ☐ User login
- ☐ Subscription purchase
- ☐ NFT minted
- ☐ NFT viewed
- ☐ **Conversion tracking set up**
- Checkout funnel
- Subscription conversions
- NFT minting conversions

Time to Complete: 30-45 minutes

16. Uptime Monitoring

- ☐ **Uptime monitor configured**
- Service: UptimeRobot, Pingdom, or similar
- Check interval: 5 minutes
- Endpoints monitored:
 - ☐ Homepage: <https://authichain.com>
 - ☐ Health check: <https://authichain.com/api/health>
 - ☐ API: <https://authichain.com/api/nfts>
- ☐ **Alerts configured**
- Email notifications
- SMS notifications (optional)
- Slack/Discord webhook (optional)

- Alert threshold: 3 consecutive failures

Time to Complete: 15-20 minutes

Legal & Compliance

17. Legal Pages

- ☐ **Privacy Policy published**
 - Accessible at /privacy
 - Up-to-date with your practices
 - Covers data collection, usage, sharing
 - GDPR compliant (if applicable)
- ☐ **Terms of Service published**
 - Accessible at /terms
 - Covers user rights and responsibilities
 - Refund policy included
 - Liability disclaimers
- ☐ **Cookie Policy** (if EU users)
 - Cookie consent banner
 - Cookie preferences page
 - GDPR compliant
- ☐ **Footer links**
 - Privacy Policy link
 - Terms of Service link
 - Contact information

Time to Complete: 30-60 minutes (if using templates)

18. Business Compliance

- ☐ **Stripe compliance**
 - Business information accurate
 - Tax forms submitted (if required)
 - Terms of Service link in checkout
- ☐ **Data protection**
 - User data encrypted at rest
 - User data encrypted in transit (HTTPS)
 - Data retention policy documented
 - User data export available (GDPR)
 - User data deletion available (GDPR)

Time to Complete: 20-30 minutes

Go-Live Preparation

19. Final Checks

- ☐ **All tests passing**
 - Manual testing complete
 - Automated tests (if any)
 - No critical bugs
- ☐ **Team access**
 - All team members have access
 - Roles and permissions set
 - Emergency contacts documented
- ☐ **Backup plan**
 - Database backup recent
 - Code repository backed up
 - Rollback procedure documented
- ☐ **Launch communication**
 - Announcement prepared
 - Social media posts scheduled
 - Email to waitlist (if applicable)

Time to Complete: 30-45 minutes

20. Go Live!

- ☐ **DNS switched to production** (if not already)
- ☐ **Final smoke test**
 - Visit homepage
 - Create test user
 - Complete test purchase
 - Mint test NFT
- ☐ **Monitoring active**
 - Watch error tracking
 - Monitor analytics
 - Check server logs
- ☐ **Team on standby**
 - Ready to fix issues

- Communication channel open

Time to Complete: 15-30 minutes

Post-Launch

21. First 24 Hours

- ☐ **Monitor closely**
- ☐ Hour 1: Check every 15 minutes
- ☐ Hour 2-4: Check every 30 minutes
- ☐ Hour 5-24: Check every 2 hours
- ☐ **Check metrics:**
- ☐ Error rate < 1%
- ☐ Uptime 100%
- ☐ Response time < 500ms
- ☐ No payment failures
- ☐ **User feedback**
- Monitor support channels
- Address critical issues immediately
- Document feature requests

Time to Complete: Ongoing (first 24 hours)

22. First Week

- ☐ **Performance review**
- Analyze traffic patterns
- Identify bottlenecks
- Optimize slow queries
- ☐ **User behavior analysis**
- Conversion rates
- Drop-off points
- Popular features
- ☐ **Bug fixes**
- Address reported issues
- Deploy patches
- Update documentation

Time to Complete: Ongoing (first week)

23. Ongoing Maintenance

- ☐ **Weekly tasks:**
 - ☐ Review error logs
 - ☐ Check database performance
 - ☐ Monitor costs
 - ☐ Review analytics
- ☐ **Monthly tasks:**
 - ☐ Database backups verified
 - ☐ Security updates applied
 - ☐ Dependencies updated
 - ☐ Performance optimization
- ☐ **Quarterly tasks:**
 - ☐ Rotate API keys
 - ☐ Security audit
 - ☐ Disaster recovery test
 - ☐ Team access review

Time to Complete: Ongoing

Emergency Contacts

Document these before going live:

```

Hosting Platform Support:
- Vercel: support@vercel.com
- Railway: team@railway.app
- AWS: Premium Support (if subscribed)

Database Provider:
- Railway: team@railway.app
- Supabase: support@supabase.com
- AWS RDS: AWS Support

Payment Provider:
- Stripe Support: https://support.stripe.com

Team Contacts:
- Lead Developer:
- Database Admin:
- DevOps Engineer:
  
```

Completion Summary

Total estimated time: **12-16 hours** (spread over 2-3 days)

Checklist Progress

- [] Pre-Deployment: __/2 sections
- [] Security: __/2 sections
- [] Payments: __/2 sections
- [] Hosting: __/4 sections
- [] Testing: __/3 sections
- [] Monitoring: __/3 sections
- [] Legal: __/2 sections
- [] Launch: __/3 sections

Total: __/21 sections complete



Congratulations!

Once all items are checked, your AuthiChain platform is production-ready!

Remember:

- Monitor closely for the first week
- Address user feedback quickly
- Keep backups current
- Rotate secrets regularly
- Stay updated on security patches

Good luck with your launch! 🚀



Additional Resources

- [Next.js Production Checklist](https://nextjs.org/docs/going-to-production) (https://nextjs.org/docs/going-to-production)
- [Stripe Production Checklist](https://stripe.com/docs/payments/checkout/accept-a-payment#before-going-live) (https://stripe.com/docs/payments/checkout/accept-a-payment#before-going-live)
- [OWASP Security Checklist](https://owasp.org/www-project-web-security-testing-guide/) (https://owasp.org/www-project-web-security-testing-guide/)
- [AWS Well-Architected Framework](https://aws.amazon.com/architecture/well-architected/) (https://aws.amazon.com/architecture/well-architected/)